

Fancy  
**Bass**  
**Chords**  
and Their Voicings

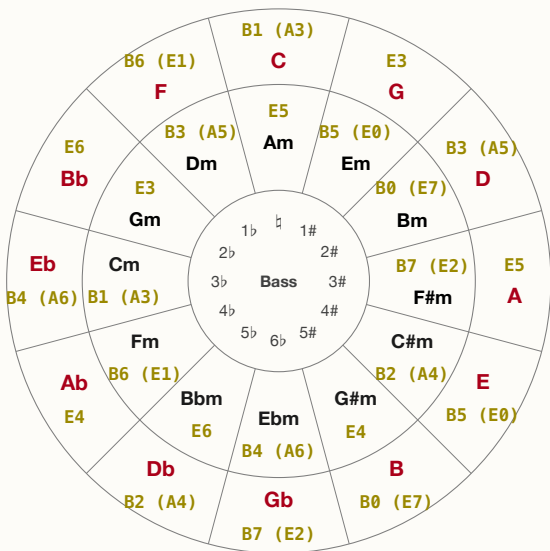
---

**(B) E A D G**



<https://fancychords.com>

## Circle of Fifths



Lowest that falls under the hand.

Five-string first, four-string in parentheses.

# Movable Shapes

Bass closed, so they move

---

shape root on bottom example

---

## fifths

|      |   |   |            |
|------|---|---|------------|
| 02xx | E | R | 13xx = F5  |
| x02x | A | R | x13x = Bb5 |
| xx02 | D | R | xx13 = Eb5 |
| 3x0x | E | R | 4x1x = Ab5 |

## major

|      |   |   |           |
|------|---|---|-----------|
| 02x1 | E | R | 13x2 = F  |
| 320x | E | R | 431x = Ab |
| x320 | A | R | x431 = Db |

## minor

|      |   |   |            |
|------|---|---|------------|
| 02x0 | E | R | 13x1 = Fm  |
| 310x | E | R | 421x = Abm |
| x310 | A | R | x421 = Dbm |

Shape is the fingering above its lowest fret.  
Slide it one fret, the chord rises a semitone.  
Bottom is the degree on the lowest string.

# Numbers

Bass the major scale, degree by degree

|           | 1         | 2         | 3         | 4         | 5         | 6         | 7         |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| <b>C</b>  | <b>C</b>  | <b>D</b>  | <b>E</b>  | <b>F</b>  | <b>G</b>  | <b>A</b>  | <b>B</b>  |
| <b>Db</b> | <b>Db</b> | <b>Eb</b> | <b>F</b>  | <b>Gb</b> | <b>Ab</b> | <b>Bb</b> | <b>C</b>  |
| <b>D</b>  | <b>D</b>  | <b>E</b>  | <b>F#</b> | <b>G</b>  | <b>A</b>  | <b>B</b>  | <b>C#</b> |
| <b>Eb</b> | <b>Eb</b> | <b>F</b>  | <b>G</b>  | <b>Ab</b> | <b>Bb</b> | <b>C</b>  | <b>D</b>  |
| <b>E</b>  | <b>E</b>  | <b>F#</b> | <b>G#</b> | <b>A</b>  | <b>B</b>  | <b>C#</b> | <b>D#</b> |
| <b>F</b>  | <b>F</b>  | <b>G</b>  | <b>A</b>  | <b>Bb</b> | <b>C</b>  | <b>D</b>  | <b>E</b>  |
| <b>Gb</b> | <b>Gb</b> | <b>Ab</b> | <b>Bb</b> | <b>Cb</b> | <b>Db</b> | <b>Eb</b> | <b>F</b>  |
| <b>G</b>  | <b>G</b>  | <b>A</b>  | <b>B</b>  | <b>C</b>  | <b>D</b>  | <b>E</b>  | <b>F#</b> |
| <b>Ab</b> | <b>Ab</b> | <b>Bb</b> | <b>C</b>  | <b>Db</b> | <b>Eb</b> | <b>F</b>  | <b>G</b>  |
| <b>A</b>  | <b>A</b>  | <b>B</b>  | <b>C#</b> | <b>D</b>  | <b>E</b>  | <b>F#</b> | <b>G#</b> |
| <b>Bb</b> | <b>Bb</b> | <b>C</b>  | <b>D</b>  | <b>Eb</b> | <b>F</b>  | <b>G</b>  | <b>A</b>  |
| <b>B</b>  | <b>B</b>  | <b>C#</b> | <b>D#</b> | <b>E</b>  | <b>F#</b> | <b>G#</b> | <b>A#</b> |

Read across: in the key on the left, the four is the note under the 4. A minor key borrows the same row, starting from its six.

# Root Positions

Bass

|           | (B) | E  | A  | D  | G  |
|-----------|-----|----|----|----|----|
| <b>C</b>  | 1   | 8  | 3  | 10 | 5  |
| <b>Db</b> | 2   | 9  | 4  | 11 | 6  |
| <b>D</b>  | 3   | 10 | 5  | 0  | 7  |
| <b>Eb</b> | 4   | 11 | 6  | 1  | 8  |
| <b>E</b>  | 5   | 0  | 7  | 2  | 9  |
| <b>F</b>  | 6   | 1  | 8  | 3  | 10 |
| <b>Gb</b> | 7   | 2  | 9  | 4  | 11 |
| <b>G</b>  | 8   | 3  | 10 | 5  | 0  |
| <b>Ab</b> | 9   | 4  | 11 | 6  | 1  |
| <b>A</b>  | 10  | 5  | 0  | 7  | 2  |
| <b>Bb</b> | 11  | 6  | 1  | 8  | 3  |
| <b>B</b>  | 0   | 7  | 2  | 9  | 4  |

Fret for the root of each key on each string.  
Everything else is measured from there.

# What to Play Under

Bass      degrees from the root

|              |                  |              |                    |
|--------------|------------------|--------------|--------------------|
| <b>major</b> | <b>R 3 5</b>     | <b>°7</b>    | <b>R b3 b5 6</b>   |
| <b>m</b>     | <b>R b3 5</b>    | <b>m7b5</b>  | <b>R b3 b5 b7</b>  |
| <b>5</b>     | <b>R 5</b>       | <b>7sus4</b> | <b>R 4 5 b7</b>    |
| <b>+</b>     | <b>R 3 #5</b>    | <b>7b5</b>   | <b>R 3 b5 b7</b>   |
| <b>°</b>     | <b>R b3 b5</b>   | <b>7#5</b>   | <b>R 3 #5 b7</b>   |
| <b>sus2</b>  | <b>R 2 5</b>     |              |                    |
| <b>sus4</b>  | <b>R 4 5</b>     |              |                    |
| <b>6</b>     | <b>R 3 5 6</b>   | <b>9</b>     | <b>R 9 3 5 b7</b>  |
| <b>m6</b>    | <b>R b3 5 6</b>  | <b>maj9</b>  | <b>R 9 3 5 7</b>   |
| <b>6/9</b>   | <b>R 9 3 5 6</b> | <b>m9</b>    | <b>R 9 b3 5 b7</b> |
|              |                  | <b>add9</b>  | <b>R 9 3 5</b>     |
|              |                  | <b>madd9</b> | <b>R 9 b3 5</b>    |
| <b>7</b>     | <b>R 3 5 b7</b>  | <b>7b9</b>   | <b>R b9 3 5 b7</b> |
| <b>maj7</b>  | <b>R 3 5 7</b>   | <b>7#9</b>   | <b>R b3 3 5 b7</b> |
| <b>m7</b>    | <b>R b3 5 b7</b> | <b>m11</b>   | <b>R 9 b3 4 5</b>  |
|              |                  |              | <b>b7</b>          |

Play the root, and the fifth if there is one.

Add the tone that names the chord, the **b3** or the **b7**, only when it wants hearing.

The rest belongs to whoever is playing chords.

# Patterns

Bass counted from the root

---

## Root + fifth + octave

The default. Works under

anything in the key.

degree **R** **5** **8**

string R 1+R 2+R

fret R0 R2 R2

## Major arpeggio

Major, maj7, 6.

degree **R** **5** **8** **3**

string R 1+R 2+R 3+R

fret R0 R2 R2 R1

## Minor arpeggio

Minor, m7, m6.

degree **R** **5** **8** **b3**

string R 1+R 2+R 3+R

fret R0 R2 R2 R0

## Dominant seventh

Any 7 chord. The b7 pulls to

the four.

degree **R** **5** **b7** **3**

string R 1+R 2+R 3+R

fret R0 R2 R0 R1

## Minor seventh

The two and the six chord.

degree **R** **5** **b7** **b3**

string R 1+R 2+R 3+R

fret R0 R2 R0 R0

## Walking approach

Leading into the next chord.

degree **R** **5** **6** **b7**

string R 1+R 1+R 2+R

fret R0 R2 R4 R0

# Tunings

---

## **Bass** (B) E A D G

The guitar's lowest four strings, an octave down.



---

## **Fancy Bass Chords and Their Voicings**

Danne Stayskal

[danne@stayskal.com](mailto:danne@stayskal.com)

<http://danne.stayskal.com>

Downloads and a printable copy:

<https://fancychords.com>

Source and corrections:

<http://github.com/linenoise/voicings>

MIT licensed. Print it, cut it, sew it, give it away.

